GS4 ETHICS

109 QUOTES • UPSC CSE MAINS

A visually structured quote bank for quick revision and answer enrichment.

VALUES
INTEGRITY • PROBITY • EMPATHY • JUSTICE • LEADERSHIP

Join @Noteshub4upsc

Clickable Telegram link • Revision-friendly layout

Values

001	“Values are caught, not taught.”
002	“Try not to become a man of success, but rather try to become a man of value.”
003	“If you don't stand for something, you will fall for anything.”
004	“Values are like fingerprints. Nobody's are the same, but you leave them all over everything you do.”

Means vs Ends

005	“You cannot expect a rose by sowing the seeds of Babool.”
006	“You cannot do evil that good may come. The means must be as pure as the end.”
007	“The worth of a state in the long run is the worth of the individuals composing it.”
008	“The means we use must be as pure as the ends we seek.”

Individual

009	“The unexamined life is not worth living.”
010	“Knowing yourself is the beginning of all wisdom.”
011	“Be the change that you wish to see in the world.”

Family

012	“The family is the nucleus of civilization.”

013	“What is learned in the cradle is carried to the grave.”
014	“Family is not just the first classroom; it is the first constitution.”
015	“The family is the first and most important teacher of social ethics.

Society

016	“No man is an island.”
017	“Society is the mirror in which we find the image of our character.”
018	“Without Ethics, Society is but a Jungle, ruled by the strongest.”
019	“An eye for an eye makes the whole world blind.”

Education

020	“A school must act as a lighthouse of society, providing guidance not only to students but also to the community at large.”
021	“Gurur Brahma, Gurur Vishnu, Gurur Devo Maheshwara” (A teacher is the embodiment of creation, sustenance, and transformation — signifying their role in shaping character and values.)
022	“Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world.”

Peer

023	“As iron sharpens iron, so one person sharpens another.”
024	“Moral habits, once initiated, are shaped and polished in the company of equals.”

025	“The company you keep determines the conversations you hear, and the conversations you hear determine the actions you take.”
026	“The influence of a bad friend is more fatal than that of a beast of prey.”

Attitude

027	“We are what we repeatedly do.”
028	“If you change the way you look at things, the things you look at change.”

Law & Ethics

029	“Law is wisdom of ages without emotions.”
030	“An unjust law is in itself a species of violence.”
031	“Law is the minimum of Ethics.”
032	“Ethics without enforcement lacks teeth.”
033	“The law is the public conscience.”
034	“Without law men are beasts.”
035	“In law a man is guilty when he violates the rights of others. In ethics he is guilty if he only thinks of doing so.”
036	“It may be true that the law cannot make a man love me, but it can keep him from lynching me, and I think that’s pretty important.”

Work / Profession / Business

037	“In looking for people to hire, you look for three qualities: integrity, intelligence, and energy. And if they don’t have the first, the other two will kill you.”
038	“In looking for people to hire, look for three qualities: integrity, intelligence, and energy. If they don't have the first, the other two will kill you.”
039	“A company is only as ethical as its leaders.”
040	“I do not believe in the accumulation of wealth for its own sake, but as a trust to be used for the benefit of society.”
041	“Businesses should serve people, not the other way around.”
042	“A business that makes nothing but money is a poor kind of business.”
043	“The purpose of a business is to create a customer who creates customers.”
044	“Wealth without work, commerce without morality, and politics without principle are sins.”

Public Administration / Public Service

045	“The best way to find your-self is to lose yourself in the service of others.”
046	“Civil servants must obey lawful orders, not unethical ones.”
047	“Effectiveness in public administration is not about doing more, but about doing what truly matters — with integrity and empathy.” “More is not always better”.
048	“Public money ought to be touched with the same sanctity with which a good man touches the money of orphans.”
049	“A public office is a public trust.”

Public Life / Probity

050	“The wealth of the nation is not the private property of rulers, but the trust of the people.”
051	“A king shall lose his wealth but not his integrity.”
052	“Where do the evils like corruption arise from? It comes from the never-ending greed. The fight for a corruption-free ethical society will have to be fought against this greed and replace it with ‘what can I give spirit’.”

Probity in Governance

053	“Recognized probity is the surest of all oaths.”
054	“A king shall lose his wealth but not his integrity.”
055	“Where do the evils like corruption arise from? It comes from the never-ending greed. The fight for a corruption-free ethical society will have to be fought against this greed and replace it with ‘what can I give spirit’.”
056	“Probity in public life is not an option; it is the foundation of democracy.”
057	“Probity in public life is not an option; it is the foundation of democracy.”
058	“As a society, we must evolve to a level where probity becomes a way of life, where honesty is a routine expectation.”

Corruption

059	“Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely.”

Conscience

060	“There is a higher court than the court of justice and that is the court of conscience. It supersedes all other courts.”
061	“In matters of conscience, the law of the majority has no place.”
062	“Good conscience is a continual Christmas.”
063	“The only tyrant I accept in this world is the still small voice within.”
064	“Conscience is the voice of the soul; passions are the voices of the body.”
065	“Act only on that maxim by which you can at the same time that it should become a universal law.”

Persuasion

066	“Persuasion is achieved by the speaker’s personal character when the speech is so spoken as to make us think him credible.”
067	“Not brute force but only persuasion and faith are the kings of this world.”
068	“To persuade, we must be believable; to be believable, we must be credible; to be credible, we must be truthful.”
069	“He who wants to persuade should put his trust not in the right argument, but in the right word.”
070	“Persuasion can go through obstacles that force cannot.”
071	“Character may almost be called the most effective means of persuasion.”
072	“If you would persuade, you must appeal to interest rather than intellect.”
073	“People are usually more convinced by reasons they discovered themselves than by those found out by others.”

Emotional Intelligence

074	“In a very real sense we have two minds, one that thinks and one that feels.”
075	“There is no separation of mind and emotions; emotions, thinking, and learning are all linked.”

Work Culture

076	“You don’t build an organization, You build people and people build it.”

Integrity

077	“Integrity is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching.”
078	“In matters of style, swim with the current; in matters of principle, stand like a rock.”

Empathy

079	“Empathy is seeing with the eyes of another, listening with the ears of another and feeling with the heart of another.”

Compassion

080	“Too often we underestimate the power of a touch, a smile, a kind word… all of which have the potential to turn a life around.”
081	“If you want others to be happy, practice compassion. If you want to be happy, practice compassion.”
082	“Compassion brings us to a stop, and for a moment we rise above ourselves.”

Non-Partisanship

083	“The public interest must be the sole guide, not party interest or personal gain.”
084	“A public servant must serve the government of the day, but must not be subservient to it.”
085	“An efficient civil service is one that is politically neutral and professionally competent.”

Justice

086	“Justice without values is like a body without soul.”
087	“Justice is the first virtue of social institutions.”
088	“Justice is giving everyone what they deserve.”
089	“Injustice anywhere is a threat to justice everywhere.”

Kindness

090	“Kindness is the language which the deaf can hear and the blind can see.”
091	“Wherever there is a human being, there is an opportunity for kindness.”
092	“A warm smile is the universal language of kindness.”

Leadership

093	“A leader is one who knows the way, goes the way, and shows the way.”

094	“Leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality.”

Anger

095	“Anybody can become angry—that is easy. But to be angry with the right person, to the right degree, at the right time, for the right purpose, and in the right way—that is not within everybody’s power.”
096	“You will not be punished for your anger; you will be punished by your anger.”
097	“An eye for an eye will make the whole world blind.”
098	“He who angers you conquers you.”
099	“For every minute you remain angry, you give up sixty seconds of peace of mind.”

Desire

100	“Desire without reason is blind, just as reason without desire is powerless.”
101	“Earth provides enough to satisfy every man's needs, but not every man's greed.”
102	“The more desires are satisfied, the more they grow. Thus, there is no end to desire.”

Forgiveness

103	“To err is human, to forgive the divine.”
104	“Forgiveness is not an occasional act; it is a constant attitude.”
105	“Forgiveness liberates the soul. It removes fear. That is why it is such a powerful weapon.”

Intolerance

106	“The test of courage comes when we are in the minority; the test of tolerance comes when we are in the majority.”
107	“Intolerance is a sign of weakness, not strength.”

Patriotism

108	“Ask not what your country can do for you — ask what you can do for your country.”
109	“Patriotism means to stand by the country. It does not mean to stand by the president.”